ISKCON-PONDA KITCHEN POLICY

Vision: - To create a spiritually uplifting, efficient, and compassionate kitchen that nourishes devotees and guests with sanctified food (prasadam), fostering devotion, unity, and service to Lord Krishna through every meal prepared and served.

Mission: 1. To maintain the highest standards of cleanliness, devotion, and teamwork in all kitchen activities.

2.To prepare and distribute prasadam with love and devotion, recognizing it as a sacred offering to Sri Krishna.

3.To ensure timely, nutritious, and sattvic meals for all temple residents, guests, and visitors.

4.To support ISKCON Ponda's preaching and community programs by providing Prasadam that inspires spiritual growth and harmony.

A. Daily Duties:

1. Clean the kitchen before each new cooking begins.
2. All cooking must be done after a proper bath and cleanliness.
3. Maintain full cleanliness of the kitchen, including machines, fridge and utensils.
4. Breakfast, lunch, dinner should be cooked and made ready as per temple timing.
5. Cook should ensure that bhoga is ready 15mins prior to offering. And if any other personal items are cooked then it should also be offered with main bhoga.
6. Ensure breakfast, lunch and dinner are prepared as per menu list.
7. Compulsorily looking after purchasing work when the kitchen in-charge is not available.
8. Keep the prasadam in separate utensils for brahmacharis.
9. Meals prepared should be according to the kitchen in charge direction.
10. Everything cooked within the kitchen premises must be offered to the Lord first. No mixing of unoffered into offered prasadam is allowed to avoid the offering.
11. Aprons and caps should be washed at night.
12. If any devotee makes the payments, then it should be directed to the kitchen in-charge.
13. Due to some obligation or not if any congregation devotee calls for any personal seva then permission to be taken mandatorily from Kitchen Incharge and Sub Committee Authority.
14. Notice period of 2 months when leaving the job.
15. Following cleaning responsibilities are assigned: -

    1. **Jitendra Prabhu (Kitchen In-charge)**

       Area: Prasadam Hall (must always be neat and clean), Store Room

       Machines: Big Vegetable Cutting Machine, Big Grinder, Two Weighing Machines

2. **Chittaranjan Prabhu**

   Area: Main Kitchen, Wooden Chulha Area

   Machines: Fridge, Mixer,

3. **Manoranjan Prabhu**

   Area: Main Kitchen, Wooden Chulha Area

   Machines: Coconut Grater, Atta Making Machine

4. **Ranjan Prabhu**

   Area: Main Kitchen, Wooden Chulha Area

   Machines: Tomato Puree Machine, Potato Peeler

Note: - If any devotee from above is absent, the other cooks are responsible for cleaning and maintaining that devotees assigned machines and area.

B. Spiritual & Devotional Standards

1. Everything cooked must be first offered to the Lord.
2. Mixing unoffered food with prasadam is strictly prohibited.
3. Voluntary assistance in deity worship when required.
4. Take a bath after afternoon rest.
5. Attire: Dhoti and Kurta only. Apron and caps are mandatory while cooking.

C. Coordination & Supervision

1. Follow all instructions given by the Kitchen In-charge.
2. All should use whatsapp group for communication that is messages only through whatsapp
3. Handle purchasing duties when the in-charge is unavailable.
4. All orders, tiffins and sponsors must be reported to the Kitchen In-charge.
5. Cooks cannot take independent orders without informing the Kitchen In-charge.
6. If a devotee pays any amount, it must be handed to the In-charge.
7. Notice period for leaving service: 2 months.
8. As per the instructions of Kitchen Incharge cooks can be engaged in other center programs as and when need arises.

D. Benefits and Welfare System

1. Financial & Festival Benefits

1. ₹1,000 will be given for cooking on major festival days.
2. Yearly Janmāṣṭamī Bonus: ₹5,000.
3. Yearly Increment: 6% (effective from April 2026).
4. PF (Provident Fund) system applicable.
5. ESIC scheme applicable.

2. Leave & Weekly-Off

Weekly Off (Wednesday):

Routine

1. Only cleaning and basic cooking are to be done.
2. No orders will be accepted.
3. If there is a Vaiṣṇava Tithi or festival, no weekly off.
4. One month paid leave per year. If leaves taken in between then same no. of days will be deducted from One month paid leave.
5. More than one month will be treated as unpaid leave.
6. If leave is not taken, an extra month's salary will be given. (This will be encashed only at the end of financial year).

3. Allowances & Incentives as per Matrix below:

MATRIX

SCALE OF INCENTIVE FOR KTCHEN EMPLOYEES TOWARDS ISKCON ORDER PRASAD

NUMBER OF DEVOTEES	Upto 25	From 26 to 50	From 51 to 75	From 76 to 100	From 101 to 125	From 126 to 150	From 151 to 175	From 176 to 200	From 201 to 225	From 226 to 250
MENUS										
	Rs.	Rs.	Rs.	Rs.	Rs.	Rs.	Rs.	Rs.	Rs.	Rs.
Light 100/plate	88	175	263	350	438	525	613	700	788	875
Medium 160/plate	140	280	420	560	700	840	980	1120	1260	1400
Heavy 220/plate	193	385	578	770	963	1115	1348	1540	1733	1925
Very Heavy 250/plate	219	438	656	875	1094	1313	1531	1750	1969	2188

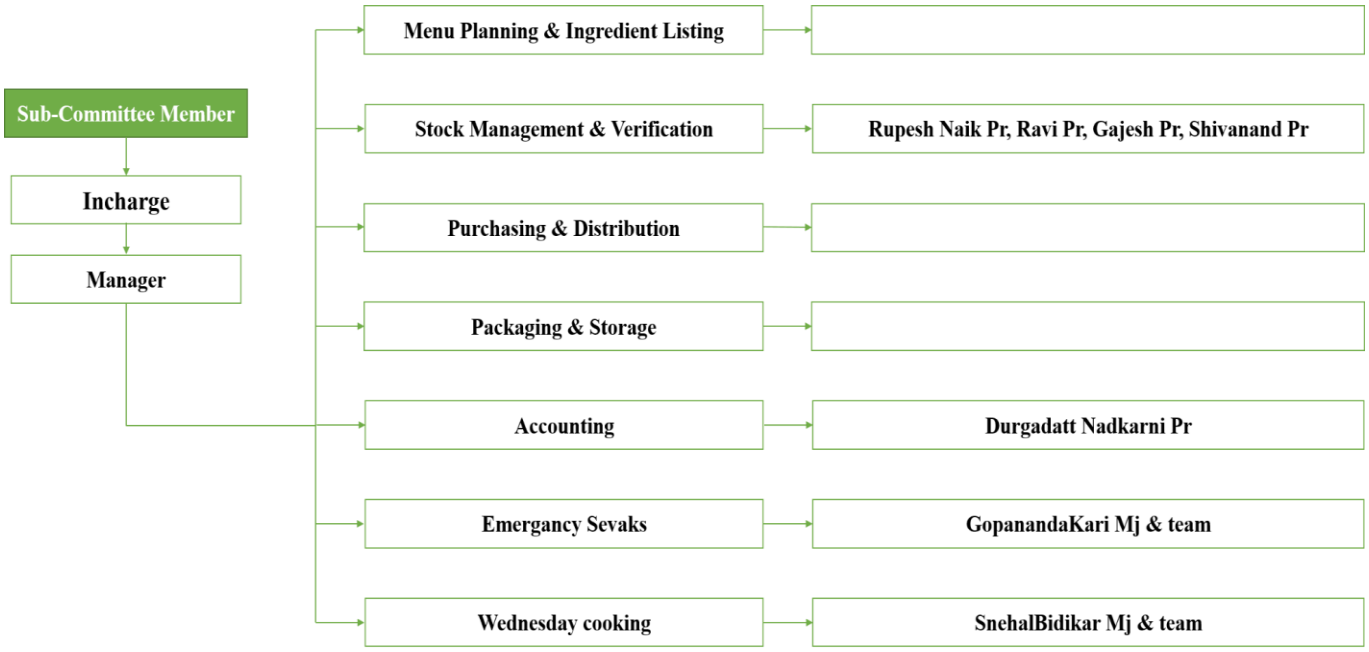
4. Additional Facilities

- Stay, prasadam and basic necessities covered by the temple.
- Medical insurance (ESIC)and emergency assistance: ₹8,000 per year.
- Weekly class for cooks (Wednesday).
- Each cook receives annually: -3 dhotis, 3 kurtas, 3 aprons, 3 caps, and 3 masks.
- Train travel tickets (sleeper class) to home & return journey will be sponsored by the temple (Only Kitchen employees and not family members).

F. Salary & Yearly Package Summary

	Particulars	Details	Annual Value(₹)
1.	Salary	Approx. ₹18,000/month	2,16,000
2.	Monthly Incentive	Approx. ₹5,000/month	60,000
3.	Yearly Bonus	—	5,000
4.	Clothing & Essentials	Dhoti, Kurta, Soap, etc.	4,000
5.	Medical Insurance & Emergencies	—	8,000
6.	Festival Allowance	₹1,000 for major programs	8,000
7.	Accommodation & Prasadam	Provided by temple	54,000
8.	PF Contribution	Yearly	20,000
Total Estimated Package		**—**	**₹3,75,000/year**

ISKCON-PONDA KITCHEN DEPARTMENT SYSTEM



Purchasing Department Structure and Team Responsibilities

Team 1: Menu Planning & Ingredient Listing

- Half monthly prepares the menu for upcoming weekly programs, temple residents and Brahmacharis.
- Lists all required ingredients according to the menu and previous stock usage.
- Ensures accuracy in quantities and specifications for efficient purchasing and preparation.

Team 2: Stock Management & Verification

- Maintains current inventory of ingredients.
- Measures and verifies quantities by weight.
- Provides updated ingredient lists and stock feedback to **Team 1** for planning.

Team 3: Purchasing & Distribution

- Receives ingredient lists from **Team 1** and procures all items.
- Delivers prasadam to employees at locations like Goa Bagayatdar to maintain good relationships with them.
- Handles billing and procurement procedures on-site.
- A research team (2 members) can be appointed by the Purchasing Section to find good quality ingredients at better prices and checking whether companies are fully vegetarian or only partially vegetarian.

Calls **Team 2** to collect all purchased ingredients and bring them back to the center.

Team 4: Packaging & Storage

- Packages ingredient bags according to **Team 1** specifications and planned dates.
- Organizes packaged bags on racks in the storage room for easy access.
- Ensures proper labeling and storage to maintain quality and efficiency.

- Follows First-In, First-Out (FIFO) method while packing to ensure older stock is used first.

Purpose Behind This System

1. Ensuring Timely Availability of Ingredients

- Previously, cooks faced delays because ingredients and vegetables did not arrive on time.
- Mismanagement and miscommunication arose due to the absence of a fixed menu.
- On-the-spot menu planning sometimes led to repeating the same menu for the same congregation program.

2. Advance Planning and Efficiency

- By planning a 15-day menu in advance and preparing an ingredients list based on count, we gain multiple benefits:
- Reduces overall expenses and avoids unnecessary purchases.
- Saves time, petrol, and effort, and minimizes risks since fast rides to buy ingredients are avoided.
- Helps maintain stock efficiently and ensures first-in-first-out usage, preventing spoilage.

3. Organized Ingredient Preparation

- Preparing ingredient bags as per the menu and count helps cooks:
- Save time searching for items.
- Prevent wastage of ingredients.
- Avoid wastage of prasadam.

4. Enhancing Service and Devotional Impact

- When visiting places like Goa Bagayatdar, all employees greet us with Hare Krishna, appreciating our efforts in serving prasadam and cultivating devotion.
- The system allows us to serve devotees more efficiently and maintain a positive, devotional impression.

5. Special Attention to Health and Quality

- The menu-making team ensures healthy and nutritious prasadam, especially for brahmacharis and residential devotees during breakfast.
- Health-conscious planning ensures devotees receive prasadam that supports their well-being.

6. Cost Control and Menu Consistency

- Outside orders often have opulent menus, which, if repeated in our programs, increase the bill unnecessarily.
- Advance planning avoids menu repetition and controls unnecessary expenditure while maintaining quality.

ISKCON-PONDA KITCHEN ORDER POLICY

To ensure a smooth and organized prasadam distribution experience for all, kindly note the following guidelines for placing any food order:

1. Custom Menu Orders:
For any special or customized menu, please place your order at least 48 hours in advance.

2. Orders for Less Than 20 Persons:
For smaller gatherings (less than 20 persons), kindly select from the pre-decided menu available on that particular day.

3. Order Confirmation:
Orders will be confirmed only after receiving 100% advance payment. Kindly note that this helps us plan and serve you better. Advance Payment is a must credited directly into ISKCON Ponda account through UPI or Net banking. Cheques are not acceptable. Kindly note that no order will be processed without advance payment.

4. Receipts Provided:
For every payment made, an official receipt will be issued.

5. No Home Delivery:
Home delivery is not available. Kindly arrange to pick up prasadam from the ISKCON Ponda Kitchen.

6. Weekly Off – Wednesday:
We do not accept any orders on Wednesdays due to other seva and kitchen maintenance.

7. Order Placement Procedure:
All orders must be placed only through the kitchen in-charge. Kindly do not request cooks or other team members for orders.

8. Pending Payments Policy:
If any devotee has outstanding dues, new orders will be accepted only after previous payments are cleared. For future orders in such cases, we request full advance payment.

9. Use of Kitchen Utensils:
Kitchen utensils will be provided only for ISKCON Satsang programs or for ISKCON devotees.

10. Prasadam Must Be Offered:
The kitchen will provide only prasadam that has been offered to Sri Sri Radha Gopinath. Please do not request unoffered food.

We sincerely thank all devotees for their cooperation. Your support helps us maintain a smooth and devotional prasadam distribution service for everyone.

11. Devotee Interaction Guidelines

1. If any devotee has given financial help or a loan to a cook, they should not ask for special prasadam through them.
2. The kitchen is meant for serving the Lord and all devotees equally.
3. Cooks may accept gifts but not money.
4. Any private exchange of money will result in strict action.
5. If a devotee wishes to give money, it must go through the Kitchen In-charge.
6. If prasadam is missed or delayed, devotees should contact the Kitchen In-charge (timing: 9 AM–9 PM), not the cooks directly.
7. Feedback about prasadam taste or quantity should be shared only with the Kitchen In-charge.
8. Appreciations and compliments to the cooks are always welcome.

Kitchen Accountability Google Sheet:

Vendor name	Amount		Date	Person name	Program	Type	Payment through	Amount	Paymt Rcvd
Rinka Marketing			4/1/2025	Person 1		Sponsor	Gpay	10000	Yes
Kasturi Enterprises			4/1/2025	Person 2		Order			No
Goa Bhagayatdar			4/5/2025	Person 3		Coupon	Cash	550	Yes
Vedit General Store									No
Jitendra Govekar									No
Shreeji Trading									No
Diksha Tendulkar									No
poonam Anand mandrekar(Kaju)									No
									No
									No
Matchless gift purchase	600								No
Gas: 0									No
Petty cash									No
									No
Cooks Overtime from Orders									No
Total Orders:	0								No
Orders 40%									No
Cooks Salary									No
Labour Cost									No
Monthly major/special programs									No
Total Sponsors:	10000								No
Sponsor 80 ingridients - 20 profit									No
									No
Total Coupons:	550								
No. of plates:									No
									No
35% of profit for cooks									No
DebitCredit Difference	9950								No
Total Tiffins:	0								No
									No
									No
							Total:	**10550**	

Confirmation & Approval

All policies have been reviewed, confirmed, and approved by the Sub-Committee Members:

Names	**Signature**
Sushant Caitanya Prabhu	_____
Anant Lila Prabhu	_____
Sankarshan Priya Prabhu	_____
Vishnu Charan Prabhu	_____
Sarva Lakshami Mataji	_____
Rupesh Naik Prabhu	_____